# Kabir Vaidya

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**Contact Information**

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**Research Interests**

Microeconomic Theory, Development Economics, Applied Microeconomics, Political Economy, Game Theory, Electoral Competition, Systemic Inequality

**Education**

**University of Glasgow**

PhD in Economics — Oct. 2023 – present

MRes in Economics — 2021 – 2023

**Fergusson College, Pune University, India**

BSc in Mathematics — 2018 – 2021

**Job Market Paper**

**Clientelism and Elite Capture:**
**Theory and Structural Estimation**


This paper extends and develops a political economy model of electoral competition where clientelism and elite capture coexist. I show that institutional frictions in a decentralised system can exacerbate inequality in equilibrium. The model uses endogenous clientelistic pressure from political party, along with voter's 'own' choice of type. As a result, in equilibrium, political preference for the elite is higher than non-elite. As a consequence, the local government's wealth redistribution policy values elite more even though non-elite are in majority. I complement the model with structural estimation using local election data from West Bengal, India. I estimate the model's structural primitives, clientelistic pressure and policy preference. The estimates validates the implications from theory. The inequality that arises from such institutional frictions are inherent in decentralised democratic systems and is structurally conditioned. The framework offers a new way analyse structurally conditioned inequality, shedding light on why imperfect democratic process in unequal societies may perpetuate rather than ease inequality.


**Awards & Funding**

CoSS Studentship, University of Glasgow (MRes + PhD) — 2021 – 2026

**Teaching**

**University of Glasgow**, Teaching Assistant — 2022 – present

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|---|---|
| ECON 1001 Economics 1A | Fall 2024, 2025, 2026 |
| ECON 1002 Economics 1B | Winter 2025, 2026 |
| ECON 1012 Introductory Mathematics for Economists | Fall 2022, 2023, 2024, 2026 |
| ECON 1013 Introductory Statistics for Economists | Winter 2023 |
| ECON 2002 Economics 2B | Winter 2025, 2026 |
| ECON 4032 Contemporary Issues in Inequality | Winter 2025, 2026 |

## Conference Attendance

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|---|---|
| **Scottish Economic Society Annual Conference**, University of Glasgow | Apr. 2026 |
| **2nd South West Economics PhD Conference**, University of Exeter | May 2026 |
| **Royal Economic Society Annual Conference**, Newcastle University | Jul. 2026 |
| **Econometric Society European Meeting** (EEA-ESEM 2026), Dublin | Aug. 2026 |
| **21st annual Conference on Economic Growth and Development**, ISI Delhi, India | Dec. 26 |

## Workshops & Training

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| **Understanding prosperity and development in modern world**, Royal Society Edinburgh, Edinburgh | Oct. 2026 |
| **Structural change, Growth & Economic Development**, led by Douglas Gollin, University of Glasgow | Oct. 2026 |
| **Diversity and the Political Economy of Social Cohesion**, Brunnel University, London | Sept. 2026 |
| **Econometrics Workshop**, led by Jeffrey Wooldridge, University of Glasgow | Apr. 2026 |
| **Causal Inference Methods**, Scott Cunningham, University of Glasgow | May 2025 |
| **GTA Workshop**, Economics Network, University of Strathclyde | Sept. 2022 |

## Academic Service

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| Student Representative for economics department | 2023 - Now |
| SES Conference, Glasgow | Apr. 2024 |
| RES PhD Conference, Glasgow | Jun. 2023 |
| Royal Economic Society Annual Conference, Glasgow | Apr. 2023 |

## Skills

**Programming:** Stata, LaTeX, Matlab, R, Julia, Python, QGIS, ArcGIS

**Languages:** English, Marathi, Hindi, Japanese (basic), Arabic (basic)

## References


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**Professor Geethanjali Selvaretnam**
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